missiles and would have prioritised their destruction. The existence of the nuclear-armed Meteors only became apparent in 1994. In *One Minute to Midnight*, Michael Dobbs provides a graphic account of how, as the crisis moved toward its climax, the missiles were moved to launch positions, fifteen miles from Guantánamo Bay.[73]

On 4 September 1962 the White House had warned about the build-up of Soviet forces in Cuba. Moscow's response was to dispatch additional tactical nuclear weapons (and cancel deployment of the Soviet surface fleet). Khrushchev was staying at his *dacha* at Pitsunda on the Black Sea, and there seems to have been no formal discussion within the Presidium.[74] Recommendations about weapons systems were submitted in writing and taken to Pitsunda. On 7 September Khrushchev authorised the dispatch of a dozen warheads (each with two-kiloton payloads) for short-range Luna missiles and nine air force Ilyushin-28 bombers (with six RDS-4 Tatyana variable-yield bombs of eight to twelve kilotons).[75] The original Soviet game plan had included a naval regiment of thirty Ilyushin-28 torpedo bombers (plus three training aircraft), equipped with 150 torpedoes and 150 mines.[76] US intelligence estimated the Ilyushin-28 had a range of some 750 miles. On one-way missions, this would have enabled them to reach Washington. According to Anatoli Gribkov, however, when equipped with nuclear ordnance, the bomber's range was 200 miles (nevertheless, able to reach some US cities).[77]

Photographs of crates in which the Ilyushin-28s were transported enabled analysts to identify them as the same used to transport the bombers to Egypt and Indonesia. By means of what the director of the National Photographic Interpretation Center, Arthur Lundahl, called 'cratology', US intelligence was aware of the Ilyushin-28s by 9 October (though the navy had photographed them on 28 September).[78] The President was briefed by McCone on 11 October.[79] Lundahl's cratology had a very mixed record. Indeed, its failings could have proven disastrous. US intelligence identified some 100-15 cruise missile crates, but assumed they were all transporting Sopka coastal defence missiles, which carried only conventional